

Nicolas Wessler

Ph.D. Candidate, UBC Sauder School of Business
nicolas.wessler@sauder.ubc.ca | nicolas-wessler.net

Research Interests

International Trade, Political Economy, Economic History

Education

University of British Columbia , Sauder School of Business	2021 - present
Ph.D. in Strategy and Business Economics	
Committee: Keith Head, Ayumu Ken Kikkawa, Nathan Nunn	
Advanced Studies Program, Kiel Institute for the World Economy (Germany)	2018 - 2019
Master of Science in Economics, University of Pavia (Italy)	2017 - 2018
Master of Science in Economics, University of Tübingen (Germany)	2016 - 2017
Visiting Student, Kasetsart University (Thailand)	2015 - 2016
Bachelor of Science in Economics, University of Münster (Germany)	2012 - 2016

Research and Work Experience

Pre-Doctoral Research Associate , University of Chicago	2019 - 2021
Prof. Felix Tintelnot & Prof. Alessandra González	
Research Assistant , United Nations ESCAP (Thailand)	2019
Research Assistant , Prof. Andreas Fuchs, Kiel Institute for the World Economy	2018 - 2019
Intern , Economic Policy Forum (Germany)	2016

Awards and Scholarships

UBC Killam Graduate Teaching Award (\$1,000)	2025/2026
ReCIPE PhD Research Grant, UK Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office (£15,000)	2025
EDI Research Catalyst Funding, UBC Dhillon Centre (\$1,000)	2024
Doctoral Recruitment Fellowship, UBC Sauder School of Business	2021 - 2026
ASP Scholarship, Kiel Institute for the World Economy	2018 - 2019
DAAD Full Year Scholarship	2017

Working Papers

The Cost of Rivalry: Geopolitical Fragmentation and Trade during the Cold War
(with Timothy Meyer, Job Market Paper)

Hegemonic Competition with Carrots and Sticks
(with Timothy Meyer)

Publications

Trade Reliance and the Success of Economic Sanctions

Review of World Economics, 2026, [link](#)

The Glass Web: Kinship Networks, Female Executives and Firm Outcomes in the Middle East

(with Alessandra L. González)

Economics of Transition and Institutional Change, 2026, Art. ecot.70037, [link](#)

Presentations

2026

- **Oct** — The Third Annual Macroeconomic Policy Perspectives Conference, Stanford (JMP, forthcoming)
- **Jul** — NBER Summer Institute on International Economics and Geopolitics*
- **Jul** — 8th International Conference on European Economics and Politics, ETH Zurich (JMP)
- **Jun** — Cowles Summer Conference on International Trade, Yale (JMP)
- **Apr** — 24th Annual GEP/CEPR Postgrad Conference, Nottingham (JMP)

2025

- **Sep** — Philly Trade Group at Drexel, Philadelphia
- **May** — 59th Annual Meetings of the Canadian Economics Association, Montreal
- **May** — Second Annual Workshop on Sanctions, Vienna
- **Feb** — Graduate Student International Political Economy Conference, Berkeley

2024

- **May** — Research in International Economics and Finance Doctoral Meeting, Paris
- **May** — 58th Annual Meetings of the CEA, Toronto

(JMP): Job Market Paper presentation *: Presented by co-author

Referee Services

Review of World Economics

Review of International Economics

Other Services

President, UBC Sauder Ph.D. Student Society

2024

Organizer, UBC Trade/Spatial Brownbag Seminar Series

2024

Teaching Experience

University of British Columbia — Instructor

COMM 394: Environment, Society and Government (Undergraduate)

Summer 2025

Enrollment: 36 students Teaching load: 6 hrs/week Teaching evaluation: 4.9 / 5.0

University of British Columbia — Teaching Assistant

COMR 493: Strategic Management in Business (Undergraduate)	Winter 2024, Winter 2023
COMR 491: Strategic Management (Undergraduate)	Winter 2023
COEC 498: Advanced International Business Management (Undergraduate)	Winter 2023
COMM 498: International Business Management (Undergraduate)	Winter 2022
ECON 455: International Trade (Undergraduate)	Winter 2022, Winter 2023

Skills

Languages: English (fluent), German (native), Italian (beginner)

Software: R, Stata, Python, Julia, MATLAB

Other Information

Born: September 1992

Citizenship: Germany

References

Keith Head

Sauder School of Business, UBC

keith.head@sauder.ubc.ca

Ayumu Ken Kikkawa

Sauder School of Business, UBC

ken.kikkawa@sauder.ubc.ca

Nathan Nunn

Department of Economics, UBC

nathan.nunn@ubc.ca

Updated: August 28, 2026